

The 12-Month UPSC Study Planner

A fillable template built around three real phases, not twelve identical months — pairs with our blog post, "How to Build a 12-Month UPSC Study Plan That Actually Survives Contact With Reality."

Five rules this planner is built on: (1) Three real phases, not a flat 12-month grid. (2) Revise every topic ~3 weeks after you first study it. (3) One unscheduled buffer day every week. (4) Track topics completed, not hours spent. (5) Review and rebuild the plan monthly — your first draft is not a contract.

The Three Phases

MONTHS 1–4

Foundation Phase

NCERT base-building across all subjects, syllabus mapping, and setting up your daily current affairs habit.

My focus subjects:

MONTHS 5–8

Prelims-Focused Phase

Concept depth, timed test series, and error-analysis-driven revision of weak topics.

My focus subjects:

MONTHS 9–12

Mains-Focused Phase

Weekly answer writing, optional subject depth, essay practice, and full-length Mains test series closer to the exam.

My optional subject & focus areas:

Month-by-Month Tracker

MONTH	PHASE	THIS MONTH'S PRIMARY FOCUS (FILL IN)	REVISION CHECK-IN (TOPIC FROM ~3 WEEKS AGO)	BUFFER DAY USED?
1	Foundation			☐
2	Foundation			☐
3	Foundation			☐
4	Foundation			☐
5	Prelims-Focused			☐
6	Prelims-Focused			☐
7	Prelims-Focused			☐
8	Prelims-Focused			☐
9	Mains-Focused			☐
10	Mains-Focused			☐
11	Mains-Focused			☐
12	Mains-Focused			☐

Monthly Review Checklist

Photocopy this section, or just re-answer these four questions at the end of every month:

- ☐ What did I actually complete this month, versus what I planned?
- ☐ Which topics needed more than one revision pass?
- ☐ Did I use my weekly buffer day, or did I skip it and pay for that later?
- ☐ What one change should next month's plan make, based on this month?

Remember: this plan is a draft, not a contract. If you're consistently falling two weeks behind by month three, the fix isn't more willpower — it's rebuilding the plan around your actual pace. A coach can help you do that rebuild without losing momentum.